Lead Generation Without an Ad Budget

You explicitly told me: no $20K-a-month Google Ads play, no Vulcan7 lists that flopped, no paying for leads at scale. Strategy has to be SEO-based, ranking-based, organic-led, leveraging what you already pay for.

This document is the lean lead-generation playbook built around your actual constraints.

What you already have (and aren’t fully using)

ASSET	STATUS	WHAT IT CAN PRODUCE
PropStream (paid monthly)	Active	Targeted seller lists, absentee owners, distressed properties, equity targets, probate, divorce
Yoast SEO Premium (paid)	Active	On-page optimization, schema, internal linking suggestions, redirects
BoldTrail / KVCore (paid)	Active, 18 drips built	Lead nurture, drip automation, behavior tracking on contacts
WordPress + Yoast + iHomefinder	Active	Long-form SEO, IDX search, blog → ranking
Google Search Console	Should be active (verify with Site Kit)	What's already searching for you, what almost-ranks
Google Business Profile (need to claim)	NOT YET CLAIMED — emergency fix from audit	Local search, reviews, posts as backlinks
Hotjar / Microsoft Clarity (FREE)	Not installed	Heatmaps, recordings, behavior monitoring on site visitors
YouTube channel	Active	YouTube SEO, embedded video on blog
Notion + Trello	Active	Track leads, follow-ups, sources
Make.com	Partially built	Wire all of this together without paid integrations
ManyChat	Partially built (broken IG handle)	IG keyword capture once handle restored

You're already paying for the engine. The lean strategy is making it work harder, not buying a different one.

Tier 1 · Lead sources you can run THIS WEEK (free or already paid)

A. PropStream filtered lists (paid · already yours)

Specific filter combinations that produce real-name lead lists:

Filter 1: Absentee Owners with Equity (potential tired landlords)

- Property type: SFR
- Owner-occupied: NO (out-of-state)
- Tenure: 5+ years
- Equity: 50%+
- Geography: Chatham, Bryan, Effingham counties **Output:** ~200-500 names per pass. These are owners who don't live in their property and have meaningful equity. Some are tired landlords. Some are inherited owners. Some are ready to sell. **Cadence:** Run weekly. Filter for additions only. **Touch:** Direct mail or skip-trace email/phone.

Filter 2: Long-tenured High-Equity Owners (potential downsizers)

- Property type: SFR, larger square footage (3,000+ sqft)
- Owner-occupied: YES
- Tenure: 15+ years
- Equity: 70%+
- Owner age (where available): 60+
- Geography: Ardsley Park, Skidaway, Habersham, Pooler, Richmond Hill **Output:** Right-sizer prospects. They have equity, length-of-stay (likely emotional readiness), and demographic fit. **Cadence:** Quarterly refresh (changes slowly). **Touch:** Personal letter + phone. Reference Bill & Sandra persona content.

Filter 3: Pre-Foreclosure / NOD

- Status: Notice of Default
- Geography: Chatham primary **Output:** Distressed sellers. Sensitive territory — not all become listings, and approach matters. **Cadence:** Weekly. **Touch:** Discrete, helpful, no pressure. Often these need a buyer, not a listing.

Filter 4: Probate

- Status: Probate filed
- Property: SFR **Output:** Inheritance / estate transition leads. Particularly relevant given your appraiser credential — you can offer estate appraisal AND listing service. **Cadence:** Weekly (aligns with court filings). **Touch:** Sensitive personal letter. Lead with appraisal, not listing.

Filter 5: Recent Divorce Filings

- Status: Divorce-related transfer pending **Output:** Court-ordered or divorce-driven sales. Your dual credential matters here — you can do the divorce appraisal AND list. **Cadence:** Monthly. **Touch:** Coordinate with divorce attorneys you build relationships with.

B. Public records mining (FREE)

Chatham County (and Bryan, Effingham) public records are searchable online for free:

- **Probate filings** — `chathamcounty.org` court records → potential estate sales
- **Tax delinquencies** — county tax commissioner sites → distressed owners
- **Code violations** — city of Savannah → tired or absentee owners
- **Building permits** — recent permits often signal pre-list prep

Tool: a simple weekly scrape (or n8n workflow) that pulls new filings, drops names into a Trello board for Muhammed to research.

C. LinkedIn job-change signals (FREE for basic, paid for Sales Nav)

People relocating to Savannah for jobs are a high-quality buyer pool:

- **Gulfstream Aerospace** — major employer, frequent senior-level hires
- **Memorial Health / St. Joseph's-Candler** — physician relocations
- **Hunter Army Airfield / Fort Stewart** — military PCSes
- **JCB North America** (in Pooler) — corporate relocations
- **Mitsubishi Power Americas** — engineering relocations
- **The Home Depot / Lowe's distribution** — corporate roles
- **City of Savannah leadership** — public sector relocations

Tactic: LinkedIn Sales Navigator (~$80/mo) lets you save searches like "moved to Savannah, GA in last 90 days, level: director or above." For free LinkedIn, search manually and use connection

requests with personal notes. Comment on relocation announcements within 24 hours — be the first warm voice.

D. Google Alerts (FREE)

Set up alerts for: - “moving to Savannah” - “relocating to Savannah” - “Savannah real estate” (filtered) - Specific competitor agent names (know what they’re getting press for) - “Tybee Island short-term rental” (regulatory news = reactive content)

Most alerts produce weak signal. The ones that work give you a content reaction window.

E. Reddit / community presence (FREE)

- **r/Savannah** — active subreddit. Helpful answers to relocation questions earn long-term goodwill.
- **r/realestate** + **r/firsttimehomebuyer** — answer one Savannah-specific question per week with substance.
- **r/MilitaryFamilies** — for Hunter AAF / Fort Stewart relocator outreach.

Rule: never sell. Be helpful. Username appears next to a great answer = long-term local-expert positioning.

F. Local Facebook Groups (FREE)

- “Savannah Buy / Sell” type groups
- Neighborhood-specific groups (Ardsley Park residents, Skidaway, Tybee, Pooler)
- Coastal Empire moms / parents groups
- Military spouse groups
- Local business networking groups

Rule of thumb: 80% helpful contribution, 20% (or less) self-reference. Groups ban heavy promoters fast. The agents who win on Facebook are the ones who show up consistently and don’t sell.

G. Nextdoor (FREE)

Hyper-local. Position yourself as the local appraiser-realtor who answers neighborhood market questions. Verified-business profile. Comment helpfully on neighborhood threads about home values, listings, neighborhood character.

Tier 2 · Inbound signal capture (FREE setup)

Microsoft Clarity (FREE — fully featured, no payment tier)

Install on `savannahhomesandlifestylewithnik.com`. Captures:

- Session recordings (watch real visitors browse)
- Heatmaps (where they click, scroll, hover)
- Frustration signals (rage clicks, dead clicks)
- Insights (which pages convert visitors into bookings)

Within 2 weeks of installation, you'll know: - Which blog posts visitors actually read vs bounce - Where on the page they stop scrolling - Whether the Microsoft Bookings CTA is being seen - What they're trying to click that doesn't work

Free forever. Zero performance impact. Cookie-compliant. Install via Site Kit or Yoast integration.

Hotjar (FREE tier)

Similar product, free tier. Most agents use Clarity OR Hotjar — pick one.

Google Search Console (FREE — should already be installed)

Once a week, check: - Top 10 search terms bringing people to your site - Which terms you rank in positions 11-20 (one effort push moves them to first page) - Which pages get clicks but low ranking (optimization candidates) - Which terms generate impressions but no clicks (meta description rewrite candidates)

This single 30-minute weekly habit is the difference between SEO-as-prayer and SEO-as-strategy.

Google Analytics 4 (FREE — should already be installed via Site Kit)

Goal: track which content drives Microsoft Bookings clicks and form submissions. Set up Conversions for: - Microsoft Bookings link clicks - Contact form submissions - Newsletter signups - Phone number clicks (event tracking)

Tier 3 · Outbound that actually works (low cost, high effort)

A. The "5 a Week" personal email cadence (FREE)

This is in Lane 3 of the original campaign. Five personal emails per week to past clients or warm contacts. Not a drip — a real email that references something specific. Over a year, 260 personal touches build a referral engine no paid lead source can match.

B. The hand-written note (LOW COST)

Send 2-3 handwritten notes per week to past clients, ICBT (in-the-clouds-but-targeted) prospects, and people you want to know better. Cost: stamps + cards. Return: meaningful in a digital-everything world.

C. The phone-call campaign (FREE)

For the PropStream lists above, the conversion isn't email. It's the call.

- 20 calls a week from a clean PropStream list
- 5 contact rate (typical)
- 2 actual conversations
- 1 productive (asks for follow-up, says "interesting timing")
- ~ 1 listing conversation per quarter from this rhythm

20 calls × 50 weeks = 1,000 calls a year. At a 1-in-100 listing-conversion rate that's 10 listings purely from cold-list calling. Multiply by your average commission and that's a six-figure floor without a single ad dollar.

D. The "I'd love your honest take" referral ask (FREE)

To past clients, twice a year, send: "I'm hoping to focus this year on helping people who'd actually appreciate the way I work. If anyone in your circle is thinking about Savannah real estate — buying, selling, even just curious — I'd love an introduction."

Most people want to refer the right realtor. Most realtors never ask. The ask is what unlocks the referral.

E. Vendor and adjacent-professional partnerships (FREE)

Build coffee relationships with: - Mortgage lenders (especially VA / FHA specialists for military) - Estate planning attorneys (for probate / estate appraisal cross-referrals) - Divorce attorneys (for divorce appraisal cross-referrals) - Home stagers - Home inspectors - Insurance agents (especially flood specialists) - Builders (Pooler new construction) - Interior designers and architects

One coffee per week. Over a year, you’ve built 50 reciprocal-referral relationships. Many of these will produce more leads than any paid source.

Tier 4 · Paid-but-cheap (when budget allows)

When you have $200-500 a month available:

A. Yoast SEO Premium (you have this) - keep

The internal-linking suggestions alone justify the subscription.

B. LinkedIn Sales Navigator (~$80/mo)

Job-change tracking + saved searches. Higher signal than ads.

C. Targeted LinkedIn Sponsored Content ($100-300/mo)

NOT to compete with Google Ads at scale. Use to amplify ONE high-performing piece of content (a blog post about military relocation, for example) to a tightly defined audience. Boost performance, not awareness.

D. Facebook Boosted Post (one specific high-engagement organic post, $30-100)

Boosting a post that’s already pulling beats running a new ad from scratch.

What kills lean lead-gen

- ❌ Spreading 1 hour across 20 sources daily — pick 3, do them well
- ❌ Buying lists from “expired listing” services like Vulcan7 — generally low-yield, especially in tight markets
- ❌ Cold-calling without a context (PropStream filter or referral basis gives you context)
- ❌ DM blasting on Instagram (looks spammy, likely ban)
- ❌ Replying to FB Marketplace home sellers as a Realtor (rules-of-the-platform issue)
- ❌ Spending an afternoon on Canva graphics that nobody saves

- ❌ Buying Zillow Premier Agent without first dominating organic Zillow (free profile, reviews, badges)

The 90-day lean lead-gen sequence

WEEK	ACTION
1	Install Microsoft Clarity. Claim both GBPs. Resolve broken IG handle. Set up Google Alerts.
2	Run 5 PropStream filtered queries. Clean leads, drop in BoldTrail.
3	Personal touches: 5 past clients, 2 handwritten notes. Start LinkedIn job-change monitoring (free).
4	First blog publish (#04 Pre-Listing Comparable Analysis). Submit for indexing.
5-12	Publish one blog per week. Continue 5 personal touches per week. Make 20 calls per week from PropStream lists.
13	First 90-day review. Which sources produced actual conversations? Double down.

By month 4, expect: 5-10 new contacts per week from inbound (blogs + Search Console traffic), 3-8 from direct PropStream + calls, 1-3 from Lane 3 referrals, 0-2 from social organic. Total: 9-23 new contacts per week, all without paid ads.

That's the lean strategy. It compounds.

What I'd do first this week

1. Install Microsoft Clarity (10 minutes)
2. Claim Google Business Profiles (1 hour each, both Realty + Appraisals)
3. Run PropStream Filter 2 (long-tenured high-equity owners) for Ardsley Park + Skidaway. Pull names. Drop into BoldTrail. Plan to call 5/day for the next 4 weeks.

4. Publish the first blog (#04 Pre-Listing Comparable Analysis) using `10_blog_posts/04_pre_listing_comparable_analysis.md`. Submit for indexing in Search Console.
5. Send 5 personal-touch emails to past clients before Friday.

That’s the lean lead-gen playbook in one week of work. No ad spend. No subscriptions added. Compound from there.